simultaneous raids on each location, with Americans waiting outside. One of the teams captured Zubayda in an upscale house in Faisalabad, where they also found bomb-making equipment and $100,000 in cash.[128] The central Punjab city has long been a Lashkar stronghold and it appears that Zubayda chose Faisalabad as the location in which to establish his new operational headquarters.[129] A number of suspected Lashkar members were also captured during the raid, but according to media reports the Pakistani authorities released sixteen of them a month later, despite American protests.[130]

Dabbling in Open Fronts

Lashkar's historical connections to Afghanistan lay in Kunar and Nuristan provinces, which are located in the northeast of the country. The Afghan Salafis there had provided early support to Lashkar's parent, Markaz al-Dawa wal-Irshad, and one of the group's first training camps was based in Kunar. Lashkar members maintained a relationship with the Afghan Salafis there during the 1990s, some of whom fought with the Northern Alliance against the Taliban prior to 9/11. Following the destruction of the Taliban government in 2001 there was an intense rivalry among various factions to gain control of Kunar province. The organization that had aided Saeed and Lakhvi when they first launched MDI, Jamiat al-Dawa al-Quran wal-Sunna [JuDQS], emerged from a scrum of competing factions as one of the most functional political entities in the area. Haji Rohullah who led JuDQS and was the most prominent Salafi leader in Kunar was chosen as a delegate to the Emergency Loya Jirga that elected Hamid Karzai as the new head of state. However, he was arrested in August 2002 for allegedly collaborating with the Taliban and al-Qaeda, though several observers noted the possibility that a rival engineered his arrest.[131] This episode contributed to disaffection among Rohullah's followers and coincided with a series of other incidents that angered locals, leaving some of them open to insurgent recruitment.[132]

Sporadic fighting began in late 2002 when the US army's 82nd Airborne arrived in the Korengal Valley, though according to one expert the Americans were 'chasing ghosts' because insurgent activity amounted to low-level hit-and-run affairs.[133] Those associated with JuDQS appear to